Stayman and Jacoby Transfers

The Stayman convention is used to find a 4-4 Major suit fit after one partner has opened 1NT or 2NT. Responder bids an artificial 2♣ and the Notrump bidder then bids a 4-card Major if she has one, or 2 or 3 ♦ otherwise.

The Jacoby Transfer convention is used to uncover a 5-3 Major suit fit after one partner has opened 1NT or 2NT. A response of ♦s asks opener to bid ♥s, a response of ♥s asks opener to bid ♠s.

The two conventions complement each other, that's why they are together in this set of practices.

Board: 1
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♦3

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♠
Declarer: East
Lead: ♠J

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4♠
Declarer: South
Lead: ♣5

Board: 4
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♥
Declarer: West
Lead: ♣K

Board 1
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ K 9 8 6 4 ♥ A K 5 3 ♦ J 8 ♣ 6 4	
♠ 10 2 ♥ 7 4 ♦ Q 10 7 4 ♣ A J 8 7 5	N W E S	♠ Q J 3 ♥ 10 9 8 2 ♦ 9 6 3 ♣ K 3 2
	♠ A 7 5 ♥ Q J 6 ♦ A K 5 2 ♣ Q 10 9	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1NT
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	3♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			

4♠ by North
Lead: ♦3

Because NORTH holds a 4-card Major suit, (♥s), he starts his responses with Stayman.

SOUTH denies holding any 4-card Major suit so NORTH gives up on ♥s. He next bids ♠s, showing five of them. He jumps to 3♠, giving SOUTH the choice between 4♠ or 3NT.

With three trumps SOUTH chooses 4♠.

Board 2
East Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ 10 4 2 ♥ 9 3 ♦ Q 9 6 4 ♣ 9 8 7 2	
♠ Q 8 6 5 ♥ K 7 6 4 ♦ A 3 2 ♣ 5 4		♠ A K 7 3 ♥ Q J 2 ♦ J 5 ♣ K Q J 6
	♠ J 9 ♥ A 10 8 5 ♦ K 10 8 7 ♣ A 10 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1NT	Pass
2♣	Pass	2♠	Pass
3♠	Pass	4♠	
All Pass			

4♠ by East
Lead: ♠J

WEST has a poor 9 points, but does have two 4-card Majors. So he uses Stayman.

When EAST bids ♠s, WEST isn't strong enough to bid game herself, so she temporizes with a 3♠ invitation.

EAST has a full 17 points so he accepts the invitation.

Board 3
South Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ J 10 8 7 6 5 ♥ 9 ♦ A Q 5 ♣ 10 7 2	
♠ 9 4 ♥ 10 8 6 4 3 2 ♦ 7 6 3 2 ♣ 5	N W E S	♠ A 3 2 ♥ K J ♦ J 8 4 ♣ A K 9 6 3
	♠ K Q ♥ A Q 7 5 ♦ K 10 9 ♣ Q J 8 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1NT
Pass	2♥	Pass	2♠
Pass	3♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			

4♠ by South
Lead: ♣5

NORTH, with 9 points and a 6-card suit, knows they should play in ♠s. The question is: how high?

NORTH transfers SOUTH to ♠s, then invites by raising to 3♠.

SOUTH has only two trumps, (good ones, admittedly), but she has a maximum 17 point hand. So she bids the ♠ game.

Board 4
East Deals
Both Vul

	♠ A 6 3 ♥ 8 ♦ 10 7 5 4 3 ♣ K Q J 5	
♠ Q 7 4 2 ♥ Q J 10 7 5 ♦ K 6 ♣ 8 3		♠ K J 5 ♥ A K 6 ♦ A Q 2 ♣ 10 7 6 2
	♠ 10 9 8 ♥ 9 4 3 2 ♦ J 9 8 ♣ A 9 4	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1NT	Pass
2♣	Pass	2♦	Pass
2♥	Pass	4♥	
All Pass			

4♥ by West
Lead: ♣K

WEST, with a 5-card AND a 4-card Major first uses Stayman.

EAST denies a 4-card Major, so WEST realizes that ♠s are out. He then bids ♥s, promising five of them.

EAST not only has three ♥s, she also has 17 points so she bids 4♥.